

The Shattered Crown - Dungeon Master's Guide

Summary: The party must stop Duke Blackwood from completing the ritual to restore the Shattered Crown.

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What Happened

The party must stop Duke Blackwood from completing the ritual to restore the Shattered Crown. Final dungeon crawl and epic boss battle.

Key Encounters: Research Challenge - Investigation and History checks Combat: Animated Armor - Medium difficulty Puzzle: The Coded Manuscript - Decipher ancient text Discovery: Location of Temple - Find where the ritual will occur.

Key Encounters: Chase: Through the City - Skill challenge chase Combat: Duke's Agents - Hard encounter Social: Confrontation with Duke - Final social encounter before Act 3 Discovery: Duke Escapes - Sets up Act 3.

Clues to Reveal: The prince is alive but weakened Duke is performing the ritual The party must stop him before it completes.

Key Encounters: Combat: Final Guardians - Very hard encounter Puzzle: The Crown Altar - Final puzzle Combat: Ancient Guardian - Very hard encounter (construct) Discovery: Final Fragment - Recover the last fragment.

Key Encounters: Boss Battle: Duke Blackwood - Epic final encounter Phase 1: Duke with 4 fragments (Hard) Phase 2: Duke with all 5 fragments (Very Hard) Phase 3: Duke transformed (Extreme).

Resolution Options: Good Ending: Party defeats Duke, saves prince, returns fragments to safety Neutral Ending: Party defeats Duke but fragments are scattered Bad Ending: Duke completes ritual, party must deal with consequences.

This campaign is designed to be flexible and adaptable. Use this guide as a framework, but don't be afraid to deviate based on player actions and interests. The most important thing is that everyone has fun!

Clues to Reveal: The ritual is almost complete Duke is in the final chamber The party must act now.

The campaign revolves around the disappearance of Prince Aldric, the young heir to the throne of Aetheria. As the party investigates, they uncover a conspiracy involving Duke Blackwood, who seeks to seize power by using an ancient artifact known as the Shattered Crown.

Major NPCs: Duke Blackwood (Final Boss) Ancient Guardian (Construct, Neutral) Prince Aldric (Rescued NPC).

Additional Details

Clues to Reveal: The cult serves an ancient evil Duke Blackwood is their leader The ritual is almost complete.

Clues to Reveal: The Temple of the Shattered Crown location The ritual requires a blood sacrifice Prince Aldric is the intended sacrifice.

Clues to Reveal: Duke has 4 of 5 fragments The party has 1 fragment The final fragment is in the Temple.

Clues to Reveal: The Temple is a pocket dimension Time moves differently inside Duke is already inside.

Personality: Scholarly, helpful, cautious Goals: Preserve knowledge, stop dark magic Secrets: Knows how to destroy the fragments.

Type: Legendary (when complete), Rare (individual fragments) Properties: Each fragment grants different powers.

Prince Aldric is the intended sacrifice The Temple is a pocket dimension Duke has made a pact with an ancient evil The complete crown corrupts its wielder.

Act 1: Fast-paced investigation and discovery Act 2: Slower, more methodical political intrigue Act 3: High-stakes action and final confrontation.

Allow players to choose their approach Reward creative solutions Adapt to player choices Let players shape the story.

Climax: Final battle with Duke Blackwood and resolution of the campaign.

Rewards: Final fragment 500 gold Legendary magic items.

Notable Encounters: Temple Guardians Shadow Creatures Ancient Guardian Duke Blackwood (final boss).

Content Breakdown

Type	Count
Decisions	12
Insights	1
Actions	2
Concepts	4
Questions	4